AI Bootcamp — Week 4: Coaching Readiness & Certification Gate

Wednesday — Student Exercise Guide

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OBJECTIVES

By end of Week 4, the candidate is cleared for Deep Learning Program (DLP) engagement — meaning they can:

- Deliver the player-coach model in a live pairing session with a Basic Prompting-level developer
- Recognize the difference between real adoption and polite compliance
- Handle the four most common resistance patterns (skeptic, over-truster, identity-protective senior, management blocker)
- Explain EDD, RTCC (WHO/WHAT/WHY/HOW), the load-bearing rule, and the Prompt/Harness/Model framework clearly to a developer who has never heard of any of them
- Produce artifacts that a client can use after the Embedded Engineer is gone
- Articulate the full DLP arc: two 6-week loops, 6 Trainer sessions landing at weeks 1/3/5/7/9/11, the introduce-then-reinforce cadence, the transfer model (workspace to real codebase), and the Stage 3 to Stage 4 trajectory
- Operate their half of the two-person delivery model: Trainer touchpoints, escalation rules, and the Week 12 joint rubric
- Pass the Certification Gate

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TIMING

- **Monday–Friday:** 9:00 AM – 5:00 PM with 1-hour lunch (7 hours each day)

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WEDNESDAY (9:00 AM – 5:00 PM): THE DLP OPERATING MODEL AND ARTIFACT HANDOFF PREPARATION

9:00 – 10:30 AM — THE DLP OPERATING MODEL

An Embedded Engineer never delivers a DLP alone. The engagement is a two-person model: the Trainer delivers 6 four-hour sessions (weeks 1, 3, 5, 7, 9, 11) and the Embedded Engineer is the daily presence for all 12 weeks. The cadence is **introduce → reinforce**: each session lands at the start of a 2-week block, participants leave with a working artifact, and the Embedded Engineer spends the following two weeks coaching the transfer of that artifact from the shared student workspace to the client's real codebase.

Walk through the operating commitments from the EE Implementation Guide (`../AI-Deep-Learning-Program/Embedded Engineer/EE-Implementation-Guide.md`):

- **The weekly Trainer touchpoint (30 min, every week, all 12 weeks).** The Embedded Engineer owns the invite. Fixed agenda: participant pulse (2–3 specific observations), one coaching challenge, participant questions, one real artifact example from the week, session prep for anything coming in the next 1–2 weeks. Documented in field notes within 24 hours.
- **The `[PROGRAM FEEDBACK]` loop.** When something in the program design does not work for this client, capture it in touchpoint notes with the `[PROGRAM FEEDBACK]` label. This is how the program improves; silence is how it stagnates.
- **Escalation rules.** If it requires changing how the client manages the engagement (manager discouraging participation, participants pulled from sessions, scope creep), escalate to the Account Manager or Executive Coach, same day, not at the weekly touchpoint. If it is a coaching or technical blocker (tool access, repository permissions), the Embedded Engineer owns it with a 24-hour fix target. Participant resistance is never escalated; it is coached.
- **The posture shift.** Loop 1 (weeks 1–6): lead more, demonstrate, pair closely. Loop 2 (weeks 7–12): coach independence, ask more and show less, do not rescue. The **independence checks at Weeks 8 and 10** (the team runs the full workflow with the Embedded Engineer absent) are the objective test of whether the posture shift worked.
- **The Week 12 close.** The Program Completion Rubric is completed jointly with the Trainer: each assesses independently against Craft, Evaluate, Iterate, Adopt, then align. The **handoff document** records each skill's transfer status: "transferred and in use," "transferred but needs iteration," or "workspace-only, not yet transferred." Participants exit with **commitment statements**: specific, observable, next-sprint behavior changes.

Discussion: which of these commitments would be easiest to let slip under client pressure? What protects it?

10:30 AM – 12:00 PM — APPLY THE HANDOFF CHECKLIST

Return to the artifact checklist from Monday. Apply it to every artifact from Weeks 1–3. Fix what fails. The bar: could you hand this artifact to a developer who just joined the client team — someone who was not in this pre-program training — and would they be able to use it correctly?

Specific checks:

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- Every skill file has a comment header: what it does, when to use it, what the expected input format is, where the EC test file lives
- Every Python evaluation script is committed alongside the skill it evaluates (in `evaluations/`), not separately
- Every adversarial agent prompt documents what it is designed to find and the severity scale it uses, not just in your head
- The load-bearing audit results are recorded: for each removed instruction, note what EC justified the removal

12:00 – 1:00 PM — LUNCH

1:00 – 3:00 PM — BEHAVIOR CHANGE CHECKPOINT

This is the hardest part of the certification gate, and the most important.

The question is not "did you build things?" You built things. The question is: **did you change how you work?**

For each artifact you are submitting, answer:

- Is this artifact in your actual daily workflow now, or did you build it for this program?
- When did you last use it? What was the task?
- If you were not in this program, would you still use it?

The program manager will ask you to screen-share a normal work session during Day 4 or Day 5. They will watch you work. If you instinctively reach for old habits and only use the artifacts when prompted, that is detectable. It is not a pass.

3:00 – 5:00 PM — REHEARSAL PREPARATION

Tomorrow you will run a simulated pairing session with a colleague playing a Basic Prompting-level developer. Prepare for it today:

- Review the AI Adoption Maturity Assessment (7 dimensions, 21 questions) to understand where a Basic Prompting participant typically scores. You will complete this same assessment as part of the Certification Gate, where the target is 3.0+ averages on dimensions 1–4 and a total in the 43–58 range
- Read the sustainment guides (`../AI-Deep-Learning-Program/Resources/Sustainment/`), especially the Managers guide's "real adoption vs. performance" checklist. This is the sharpest available lens for the polite-compliance problem from Monday: what a team looks like when adoption is real, and what it looks like when it is theater. You will coach managers toward the real column
- Decide which skill from your artifact set is the right one to introduce in a first pairing session, and why
- Prepare how you will introduce EDD to someone who has never heard of it — not as a lecture, but as a live activity

You will not have a script. Prepare by thinking, not by writing.

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